

Section 1 - Interviewing Guidelines Policy

Purpose of the Policy:

This guideline document is designed to empower interviewers at Affine with clear and actionable best practices. It serves as a comprehensive resource to:

1. Process of Nominating new interviewers into the system
2. Facilitate **effective interview preparation**, ensuring interviewers are well-equipped to assess candidates thoroughly and consistently.
3. Outline the **feedback process** to maintain transparency, accuracy, and timeliness in evaluating candidates.
4. Reinforce professional **etiquette** and behavioral standards during interviews, promoting a positive candidate experience and upholding the Affine brand.
5. Provide optimal candidate experience and assist in taking final decisions on the candidate.

By adhering to these guidelines, interviewers will contribute in building a strong, diverse, and talented workforce while aligning with Affine's core values and commitment to excellence.

Interviewer Nomination Process & Criteria

1. **Nomination:**
 - New interviewers must be nominated by their Department Head/ Reporting Manager.
 - Employees can also self-nominate, provided they secure approval from their Department Head/ Reporting Manager, specifying the skills they are eligible to interview for.
2. **Shadowing:**
 - Shadow a minimum of **2 to 3** interviews conducted by experienced interviewers to observe the process, including completing the interview feedback form.
3. **Skill Score Requirement:**
 - Carry a minimum skill score of **3 or above** from the Upskill report.
4. **Skill Evaluation:**
 - The candidate's "Skill Evaluated" status must be marked as **Approved**.
5. **Access Request:**
 - Submit a nomination request to the TA team at '**Recruitment@affine.ai**' for access to the interviewing platform on Sense portal.
6. **Availability Updates:**
 - Regularly share and update your interview availability in the designated shared file.

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Interviewing Etiquettes

Do's

- ✓ **Be Punctual:** Join the interview call on time with your video switched on. If delayed, inform the recruiter in advance so they can reschedule and notify the candidate.
- ✓ **Professional Appearance:** Dress appropriately and position yourself in a well-lit environment to represent the Affine brand positively.
- ✓ **Ensure Candidate Video On:** Confirm that the candidate's video remains on, with their face clearly visible. Report any lag or suspected lip-syncing issues to the recruiter after the interview.
- ✓ **Preparation:** Familiarize yourself with the job description and thoroughly review the candidate's resume before starting the interview.
- ✓ **Introduction:** Greet the candidate warmly, introduce yourself, and ensure they are comfortable before proceeding.
- ✓ **Comprehensive Assessment:**
 - Evaluate both technical skills against the job description and soft skills like communication, client interaction, and team management.
 - Cover all critical areas required for the role.
- ✓ **Promote Affine:** Share generic information about Affine and the team to attract the candidate and create awareness.
- ✓ **Positive Closure:** End the conversation on a positive note, ensure the candidate has no unanswered queries, and inform them that the recruiter will share the interview results soon.

Don'ts

- ✗ **Avoid Personal Questions:** Do not ask personal or intrusive questions that may make the candidate uncomfortable and harm the Affine brand image.
- ✗ **Take Your Time:** Avoid rushing the interview. Dedicate sufficient time to holistically assess the candidate.
- ✗ **Confidentiality:** Do not disclose client or project names unless essential for upcoming client rounds or preparation.
- ✗ **Compensation Queries:** Refrain from asking about the candidate's current or expected compensation details.

Interview Preparation

1. **Technical Setup:**
 - Ensure a stable internet connection, a functioning camera, and clear audio to avoid interruptions during the interview.
 - Test your video conferencing platform in advance.
2. **Structured Approach:**
 - Prepare a list of questions tailored to the job role and candidate's resume.
 - Use the STAR (Situation, Task, Action, Result) method for evaluating behavioral responses.
3. **Bias Awareness:**
 - Be mindful of unconscious biases. Evaluate candidates purely on their skills, experiences, and cultural fit for the organization.
 - Avoid assumptions based on appearance, background, or communication style.

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During the Interview

1. **Active Listening:**
 - Pay close attention to the candidate's responses and avoid multitasking during the interview.
 - Allow candidates to fully express their thoughts before jumping to the next question.
2. **Clarify and Probe:**
 - If a candidate's response is unclear, ask follow-up questions to gain better insights.
 - Avoid asking overly complex or ambiguous questions that may confuse the candidate.
3. **Time Management:**
 - Allocate adequate time for introductions, technical/behavioral questions, and a Q&A session for the candidate.
 - Stick to the scheduled duration and respect the candidate's time.
4. **Consistency:**
 - Use a standardized evaluation form to ensure all candidates are assessed uniformly against the same criteria.
5. **Follow-Up:**
 - Stay available to clarify any questions the candidates might have about the role, company, etc.

Post-Interview Process

1. **Feedback Submission:**
 - Update the candidate's selection/rejection status on the Sense platform.
 - Complete the interview feedback template with sufficient comments to support the final decision on the candidate's suitability.
 - Provide honest and constructive feedback to the recruiter, highlighting the candidate's strengths and improvement areas.
 - If rejecting a candidate, clearly state the reasons in the feedback template to guide future hiring efforts.
2. **Timely Updates:**
 - Submit the feedback form within the same day as the interview but max. within 24 hours to maintain a positive candidate experience and accelerate the hiring process.
3. **Gap Identification:**
 - Highlight any areas you could not evaluate during the interview due to lack of expertise or time. This will help the next interviewer address these areas effectively.

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Section 2 - Interviewer Rewards Program Policy

Purpose of this Policy:

This policy aims to recognize and reward eligible interviewers with a token of appreciation for their dedication and additional efforts in evaluating and identifying the most suitable candidates for Affine.

Effective Date: 16th Nov'24

Rewards Program Eligibility Criteria:

To qualify for the rewards program, interviewers must meet the following criteria:

- **Platform Requirement:** Only interviews completed and feedback submitted via the Sense platform will be considered.
- **Role Scope:** Only Technical Interviews conducted for Delivery roles are eligible under this program.
- **Interview Duration:** Eligible interviews must have a minimum duration of 30 minutes.
- **Maximum Eligible Count:** The maximum number of incentivized interviews per interviewer per cycle (post the initial 9 interviews) is 16.
- **Program Cycle:** All interviews conducted between the 16th of previous month and the 15th of the current month will be considered as one cycle. Only interviews completed with feedback will be considered.

Additional Information

- If you have conducted more than **9** interviews in a given cycle and not received your reward. Kindly share your interview details to Recruitment@affine.ai for review. Post validation if you are eligible for rewards, then the same will be paid out along with the following month's salary payout.
- Rewards for all interviews conducted from the 10th interview onwards during the given cycle will be included in the current month's salary payout.

Rewards Structure

The rewards amount is determined based on the interviewer's location and role level. Rewards will be applicable only for the eligible count of interviews from 10th interview onwards up to 25th (i.e. a max. of 16 interviews will be eligible per interviewer per cycle):

For Interviewers in India:

- **Up to Consultant Level:** INR 800 per eligible interview
- **Principal Level & Above:** INR 1100 per eligible interview

For Interviewers in the US:

- **Up to Consultant Level:** \$15 per eligible interview

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- **Principal Level & Above:** \$20 per eligible interview

Disclaimer

- *Interviewers are responsible for ensuring compliance with the program's criteria and the accuracy of the data submitted for consideration.*
- *All matters related to eligibility and payments under this policy are subject to final approval by the Management.*
- *The Management retains the authority to amend, modify, or discontinue any aspects of this policy at its discretion.*

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46 A and 47, Behind HSR BDA Complex, HSR Layout,
Sector 6, Bengaluru KA, IN – 560102.
Tel: +91-80-66790500 | Web: affine.ai | Mail: info@affine.ai

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